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THE INSTITUTIONAL EDGE

The Opening Range Breakout Playbook

A complete guide to trading the first 15 minutes of every session — the structure institutions leave behind, how to read it with volume profile, and the playbook variations we use to trade it.

ORB STRATEGY · VOLUME PROFILE · ORDERFLOW · PRICE DISCOVERY

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INSIDE THIS GUIDE

What You'll Learn

The Sessions
01

The three major trading sessions (in GMT), why the open matters, and how institutions inject liquidity at each one.

The ORB Rules
02

Our two core playbook variations — the Initial Breakout and the Break & Retest — with exact entry, stop and target logic.

Volume Profile
03

POC, VAH, VAL explained. How to use a fixed range profile on the ORB to place stops and find targets.

Orderflow Tools
04

Heatmaps, volume bubbles and footprint charts — how to confirm acceptance, imbalance and price discovery.

Confluence
05

Higher timeframe alignment and the statistical edge of stacking ORB + Volume + Orderflow.

Continuation Plays
06

Range Absorption Breakouts (RAB) and Mean Reversion setups after the initial move.

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SECTION ONE

The Three Main Sessions

All times shown in **GMT**. These are the windows where liquidity enters the market — and where the opening range is formed.

Asia / Tokyo

01

Sets the overnight tone. Lower volatility but often builds the range that London breaks. Key for pairs with JPY and AUD exposure.

OPEN 00:00 GMT
ORB 00:00 – 00:15

London (Europe)

02

The biggest liquidity event of the day. Institutional desks wake up, Asia unwinds, and directional moves are often born in the first 15 minutes.

OPEN 08:00 GMT
ORB 08:00 – 08:15

New York AM

03

The US cash equity open. The most-watched opening range in the world — where the majority of our ORB stats are derived.

NYSE 14:30 GMT*
ORB 14:30 – 14:45

* New York equities open 14:30 GMT in winter / 13:30 GMT in summer (BST vs GMT offset). Irish traders: during summer time, the NY open lands at 14:30 local time — perfect for the afternoon session.

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WHY THE RANGE MATTERS

Institutions Build the Range

When a session opens, large institutional participants — banks, funds, market makers — flood the tape with orders. They aren't chasing; they're **absorbing liquidity**, hedging, and filling resting positions.

This liquidity injection produces a concentrated auction at the open. Price rotates, buyers and sellers agree on a short-term fair value, and a **range** is carved out within the first 15 minutes.

That range is the initial balance — the footprint institutions leave behind. Once it's broken on strong volume, the market enters **price discovery** and typically continues in that direction, giving us multiple continuation setups throughout the session.

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SECTION TWO

Mapping the 15-Minute Range

Every session starts the same way. When the opening bell rings, we mark the **high** and **low** of the first 15 minutes. That's the entire battleground for the next hour of trade.

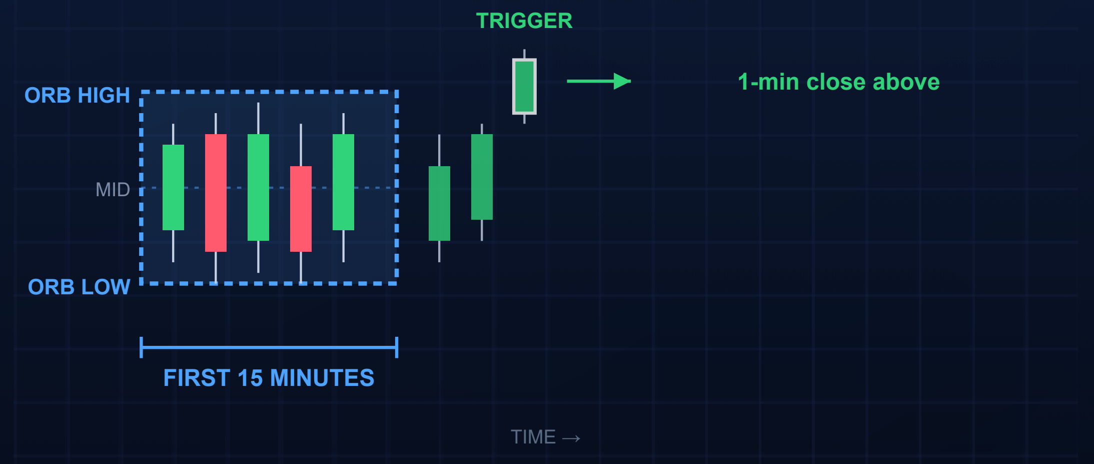
The Rules

1. At the session open, start a 15-minute timer.

2. Mark the **highest high** and **lowest low** of those 15 minutes — these are your ORB lines.

3. Wait. Do not trade inside the range.

4. Watch for a **1-minute full-body close** outside either line — that's your trigger.



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PLAYBOOK VARIATION 01

The **Initial Breakout**

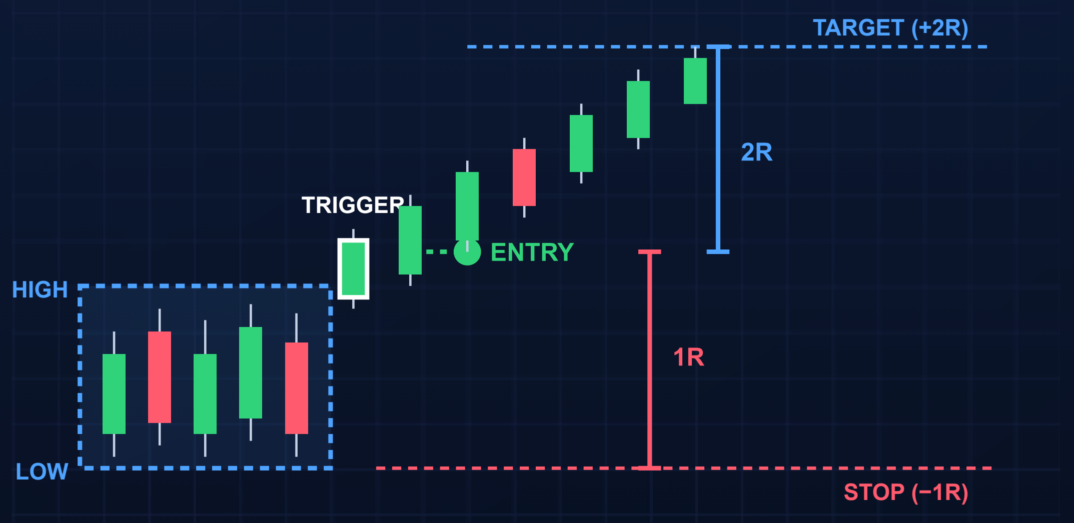
The simplest expression of the ORB. You enter on the first clean break of the range and let the move run.

Entry & Risk Rules

- **Signal:** 1-minute full-body candle close **outside** the ORB high or low.
- **Entry:** Market on the close of the trigger candle (or 1-tick above the trigger's high).
- **Stop:** Other side of the range (or just inside the opposite ORB line).
- **Target: 2R** minimum — 2× your initial risk.
- **Management:** No moving stops until 1R hit. Partial at 1R, full exit at 2R.

2 : 1
RISK : REWARD

~55%
HISTORICAL WIN RATE*



INITIAL BREAKOUT SETUP · 2:1 RISK:REWARD

* Win rate based on published ORB backtests (Zarattini, Barbon, Aziz — SSRN 4416622 & 4729284) and public 5/15-min ORB studies — historical, not predictive. See final slide for disclaimer.

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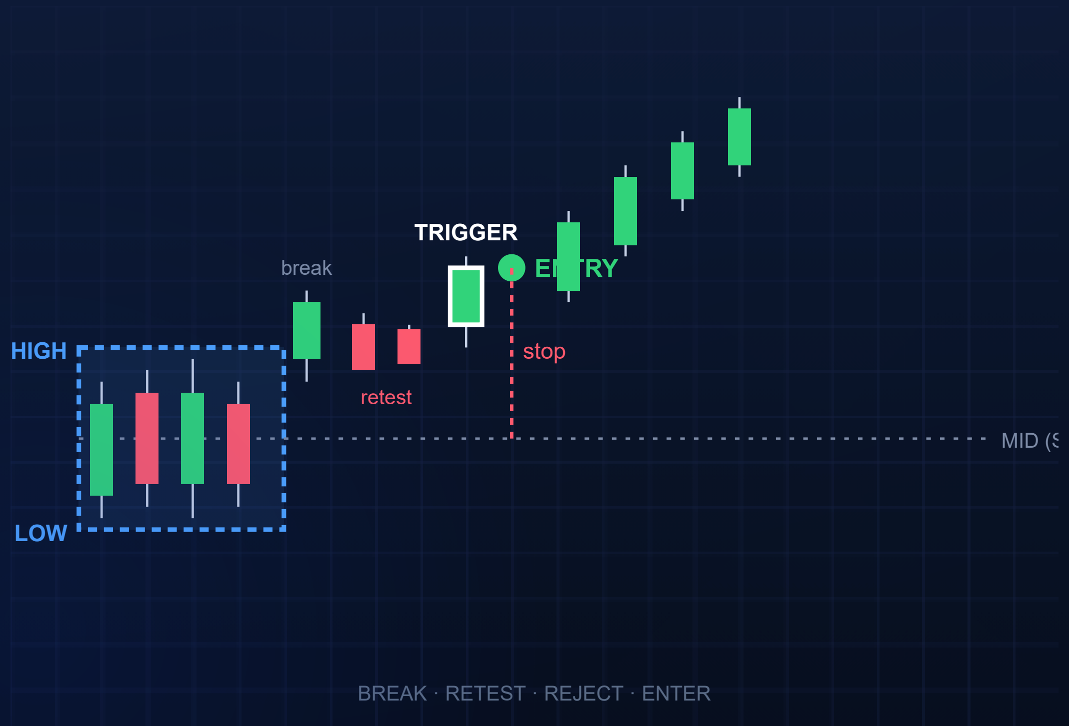
PLAYBOOK VARIATION 02

The Break & Retest

Higher conviction, better location. You wait for price to break, pull back, reject the old range and continue — then enter.



Entry & Risk Rules

1. Wait for the initial breakout candle to close outside the ORB.

2. Price pulls back and retests the broken ORB line.

3. The retest candle must **reject** the level (wick rejection / engulfing) and close back **above the initial breakout candle**.

Entry: At the close of the rejection / above the breakout candle high.

Stop: The **midpoint of the range**, or a meaningful swing just below — whichever gives cleaner invalidation.

Target: 2R+, scaling out at structure / volume nodes (see later slides).

THE FIRST FILTER

Higher Timeframe Alignment

A breakout with the trend is a trade. A breakout against it is a tourist trap. Before you take any ORB setup, check the higher timeframes.

Daily Bias

H4

Is the daily above or below its 20-period EMA? Is it making HH/HL or LH/LL? Your ORB direction should match.

Hourly Structure

H1

Where is price in the current hourly leg? Taking an ORB long right into hourly supply is low-probability.

Trend Following

M15

Pre-market: has a clear M15 trend formed overnight? Trade continuations — not reversals — on the ORB.

The Rule

Only take the **long** ORB when HTF is bullish. Only take the **short** ORB when HTF is bearish. No bias = no trade. This single filter is the difference between a coin-flip strategy and a statistically positive one.

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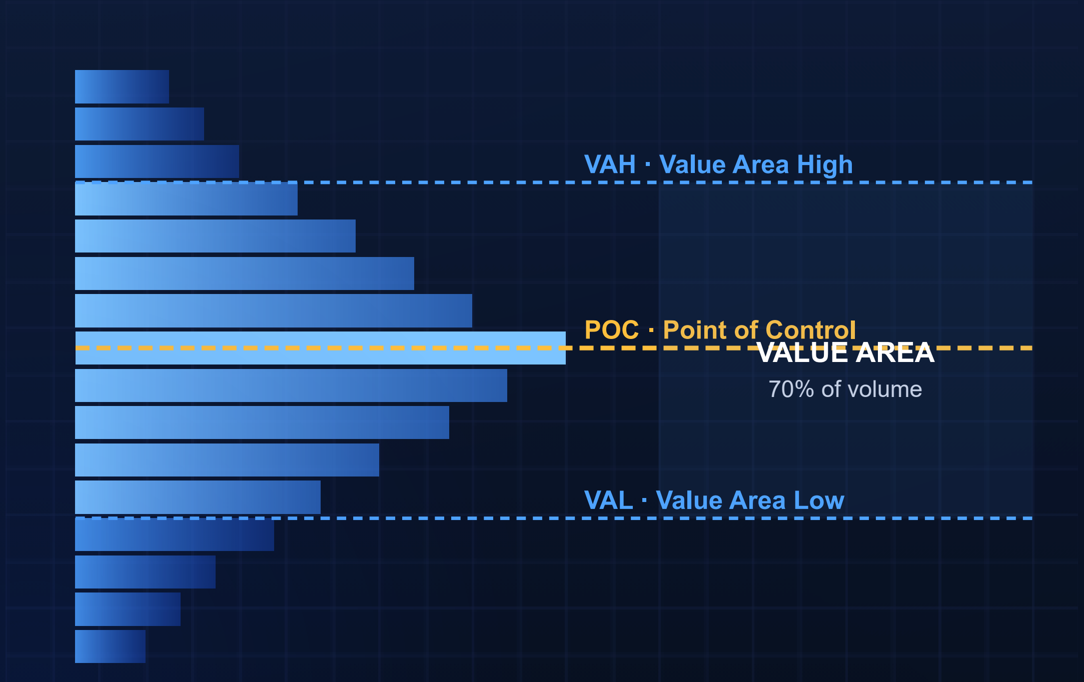
SECTION THREE · ORDERFLOW

Volume Profile **Anatomy**



VOLUME PROFILE · HORIZONTAL VOLUME DISTRIBUTION

POC — Point of Control. The price with the highest traded volume in the range. The "fair value" that acts like a magnet and a pivot.

VAH — Value Area High. The top of the zone where 70% of volume traded. A key resistance / acceptance line.

VAL — Value Area Low. The bottom of that 70% zone. Key support / acceptance line.

HVN — High Volume Node. Price thickened here → acceptance, will act as magnet / support.

LVN — Low Volume Node. Price moved through fast → rejection, price cuts through these levels quickly — perfect target zones.

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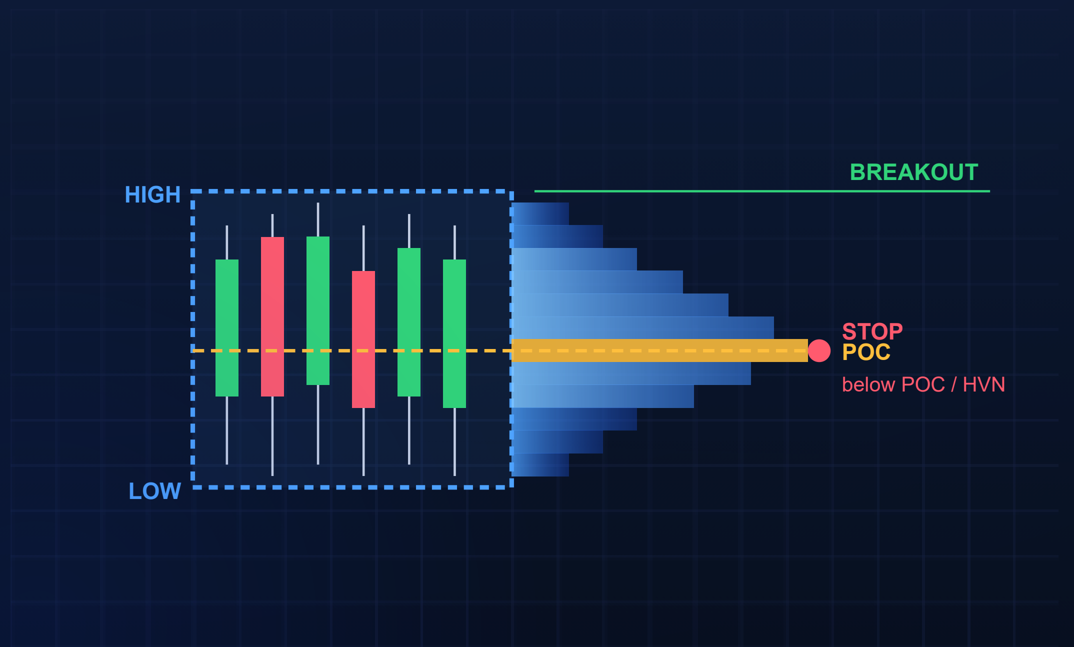
SUPER-CHARGER 01

Fixed Range VP on the ORB

Drop a **fixed range volume profile** directly on the 15-minute opening range. Suddenly your ORB lines aren't just price levels — they're volume structure.



FIXED RANGE VP ON THE OPENING RANGE

- Select the 15-minute opening range with the **fixed range volume profile** tool.
- Now you can see the POC — the specific price where institutions transacted the most within the ORB.
- Your **stop** no longer goes at an arbitrary price. It goes **behind the POC / HVN**. If price comes back through the level of heaviest interest, your thesis is wrong.
- Your stop is now tighter and sits at a structurally meaningful level.
- This is the foundation that lets us punch above the base ~55% win rate — context-aware risk.

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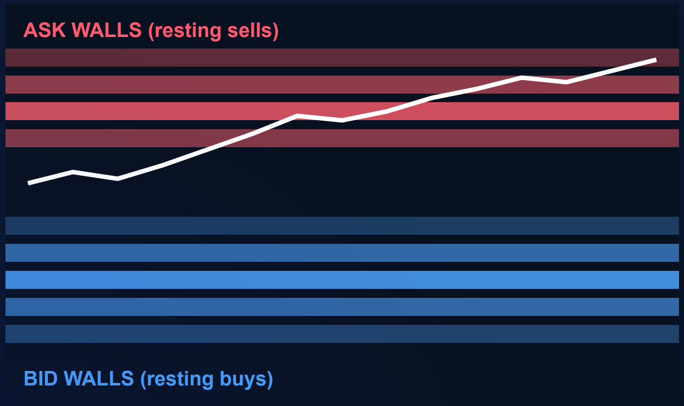
SUPER-CHARGER 02

Heatmaps, Bubbles & Footprint Charts

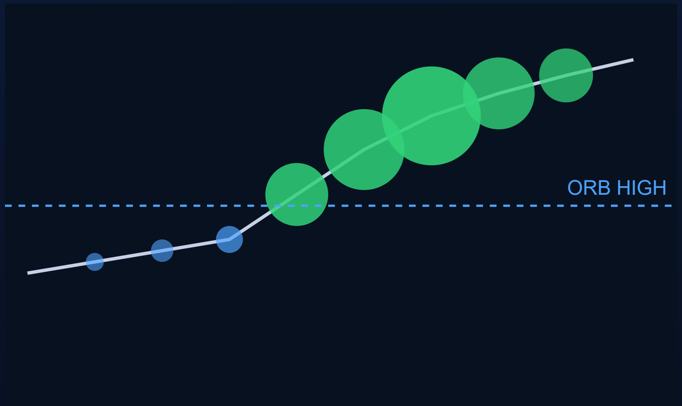
Once price breaks the range, we need to know *who* is in control. Orderflow tools let you see acceptance, absorption and imbalance in real time.

Liquidity Heatmap



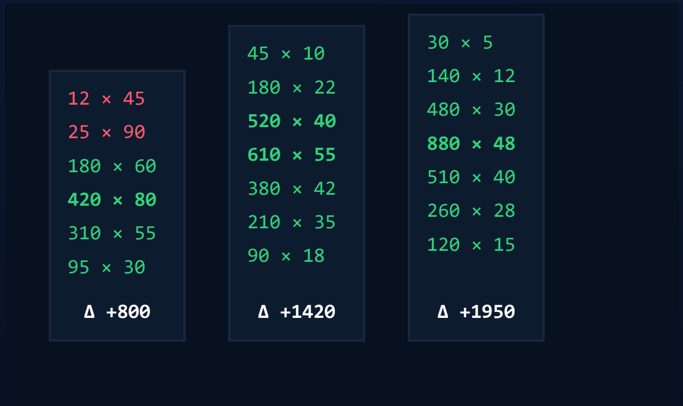
Red = resting sell orders. Blue = resting buy orders. Watch for walls that **pull** or **get eaten** — that's real flow.

Volume Bubbles



Bubble size = trade volume. Green cluster **above** the ORB high = buyers are accepting the new level and driving price.

Footprint Chart



Each cell: **bid × ask**. Aggressive green deltas stacking after the breakout = imbalance → price discovery.

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WHERE PRICE GOES NEXT

Finding Balance & Targets

When price breaks out with volume and enters **imbalance**, it searches for a new zone of agreement. Your job is to know where that is before price gets there.

THE FULL STACK

Bringing It All Together

Any one of these tools alone is a hint. Stacked together, they become a **signal**. This is the full Byond Capital ORB process.

1. Identify session. Mark the 15-minute ORB high & low.
2. Check HTF bias. No alignment, no trade.
3. Drop a fixed range VP on the ORB. Mark POC.
4. Wait for 1-min body close outside the range *or* a break & retest.
5. Confirm with orderflow — heatmap walls, bubble clusters, footprint delta.
6. Enter. Stop behind ORB POC (or midpoint on retest).
7. Target HTF POC → LVN → next HTF POC.

~74%
INTERNAL WIN RATE WITH FULL CONFLUENCE*

2R+
AVERAGE REWARD TARGET

3
CONFLUENCE LAYERS: PRICE · VOLUME · ORDERFLOW

* Byond Capital internal results combining ORB + fixed range VP + orderflow confirmation. Backtests & forward-testing on major US indices and FX majors. Historical, not indicative of future results.

AFTER THE FIRST MOVE

Continuation Playbooks

Once price is out of the range and running, the day usually offers **multiple** continuation entries. Here are the two we hunt after the initial breakout.

Range Absorption Breakout

RAB

Price consolidates **above** the ORB high in a tight secondary range while holding the breakout. Sellers are being absorbed — flat delta, shrinking volume, wicks to the upside.

Trigger: a second clean break above the secondary range, with a green delta spike on the footprint.

Stop: below the secondary range POC. **Target:** extension to the next HTF POC or LVN.

Mean Reversion

MR

Price extends too far, too fast into an HTF LVN or exhausts at a volume node. Delta starts to diverge — price makes new highs on lower aggressive buying.

Trigger: rejection wick + delta divergence at an HTF POC/VAH.

Stop: above the extreme wick. **Target:** mean reversion back to the prior HVN / ORB POC.

Most days will give you the **initial breakout**, then one or more **RAB** entries, and sometimes a late **mean reversion** into close. Plan your day in phases, not in single trades.

PRINT THIS OUT

The Rules Recap

Do

- Only trade in the direction of HTF bias.
- Wait for a **1-minute full-body close** outside the range.
- Use a **fixed range VP** on the ORB to find your POC.
- Put your stop behind the POC, midpoint, or a swing.
- Use orderflow to confirm acceptance & imbalance.
- Target HTF POCs & LVNs. Scale out in phases.
- Minimum 2:1 risk:reward or pass.

Don't

- Don't trade inside the range.
- Don't front-run the 1-min close.
- Don't take setups with no HTF alignment.
- Don't take counter-trend ORB breakouts for fun.
- Don't widen your stop once in the trade.
- Don't target random pips — use VP structure.
- Don't skip the daily journal.

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YOUR EDGE IS THE PROCESS

Plan The Trade, Trade The Plan.

This is the full ORB playbook we run at Byond Capital. Feel free to share, save, and study it. If it helps, tag us and pass it on.

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Risk Disclosure. This presentation is for educational purposes only and does not constitute financial, investment, or trading advice. All win rates and statistics are drawn from historical backtests (including published studies by Zarattini, Barbon & Aziz — SSRN 4416622 & 4729284) and/or Byond Capital internal testing, and are not guarantees of future performance. Trading leveraged instruments carries substantial risk of loss and is not suitable for every investor. You could lose more than your initial deposit. Always do your own research and consider seeking independent advice. Past performance is not indicative of future results.